DESIGN

LOGOS & BRANDING

UNIT 2



WARM-UP SPEAKING

Discuss the questions below with a partner, or answer each one in about 30 seconds.

1. Can you think of a logo you'd recognise instantly? What makes it memorable?

2. Do you think a company's logo really matters, or is it just decoration?

3. Have you ever bought something — or avoided it — because of how it was designed or branded?

4. If you designed a logo for yourself, what would it look like?

Article & Vocabulary

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 1

Read the sentences. Match each word in bold to its definition (a–h).

1 Before choosing a designer, the company drew up a clear list of **criteria** the new logo had to meet.
2 The bold red used in the original design **aroused** such strong reactions that the team softened the colour in later versions.
3 Good design should **convey** the right message about a brand within a couple of seconds.
4 A logo with rounded shapes and bright colours can feel **evocative** of childhood and playfulness.
5 Designers increasingly choose materials and processes that are **sustainable**, avoiding anything that harms the environment.
6 Even after a full rebrand, the company decided to **retain** its original mascot, since customers loved it.
7 The first version of the logo was simple; every **subsequent** update added a little more detail.
8 A strong logo can **reinforce** a company's reputation for reliability every single time a customer sees it.

a (adj) next; happening after something else
b (n) standards used for judging something
c (v) to keep; to continue having
d (v) to make someone have a particular feeling or reaction
e (v) to express an idea so that it is understood by other people
f (adj) making a person remember or feel a particular thing
g (adj) causing little or no damage to the environment and able to continue for a long time
h (v) to provide more support for an idea and make it seem true

Complete the sentences with the correct form of a word from either article.

1. Environmental _____ has become one more factor designers must consider today. (sustainable)
2. The brand's mascot has become closely _____ with reliability in customers' minds. (associate)
3. Years of small _____ turned a cluttered original design into something clean and modern. (refined)
4. A memorable logo can offer real _____ to a company's reputation over time. (reinforce)
5. What one design _____ should a new logo satisfy above all others? (criteria)

WHAT MAKES A LOGO WORK?

1 A good logo does an enormous amount of work in a very small space. In roughly the time it takes to glance at a phone screen, it needs to **convey** who a company is, what it stands for, and why it deserves attention — through little more than a shape, a colour, and sometimes a few letters. Ask ten designers what **criteria** a logo must meet, and you'll likely get ten slightly different lists, but a few themes come up again and again.

2 Simplicity is usually near the top. Studies that show people hundreds of unfamiliar logos consistently find that the ones remembered later share simple, uncluttered designs. A cluttered logo may look impressive up close, but shrink it down to a phone icon and the detail disappears entirely.

3 A logo also needs to be distinctive enough that people don't confuse it with a competitor's, while still being **evocative** of the right feeling. A children's toy brand might choose a colourful, playful design specifically because it's meant to feel fun and nostalgic, while a bank's logo is far more likely to look serious and dependable — a mismatch between feeling and industry can quietly undermine trust before a customer reads a single word.

4 Logos also need to survive change. A brand's first design is rarely its last: as tastes shift and technology changes, most **subsequent** versions simplify rather than complicate the original. A well-known athletic brand's swoosh, for example, has barely changed in decades, even as everything around it has been transformed. **Retaining** a recognisable core while updating small details lets a brand feel current without losing the customers who grew up trusting it.

5 Increasingly, companies also think about how a logo behaves across dozens of surfaces: a shopping bag, a tiny app icon, an animated loading screen. A mark that only works printed large on a shop window is no longer enough; it has to flex to a hundred different formats without losing its identity, which is one reason so many well-known logos have been quietly simplified over the past decade.

6 None of this happens by accident. A logo that succeeds tends to **reinforce** a brand's message every single time someone sees it, gradually building trust through pure repetition. An increasing number of companies also factor in **sustainable** design choices — from the materials a logo is printed on to the energy used by an animated version online — treating environmental impact as one more design criteria, not an afterthought.

7 What has **aroused** the strongest reactions in recent years, though, hasn't been simplicity or sustainability, but change itself: even a small redesign can provoke surprisingly passionate backlash from loyal customers who feel, for a moment, that something familiar has quietly been taken away.

Match headings A–H to paragraphs 1–7 of Article 1. There is one extra heading you do not need.

A Doing a lot in a small space

B Why simple designs stick in memory

C The environmental cost of printing

D Matching the feeling to the industry

E Built to last without losing the core

F One mark, a hundred formats

G Building trust through repetition

H When even a small change causes a big reaction

MATCH THE HEADING

LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT - Describing emotional responses

VOCABULARY SKILL

Verb + noun collocations

Certain verbs regularly combine with the same small set of nouns to describe emotional reactions — for example **evoke memories**, or **stir up controversy**. Learning these as whole chunks, rather than word by word, makes your language sound far more natural.

evoke	feelings, memories, emotions (mixed)
inspire	confidence, awe, admiration (positive)
arouse	interest, curiosity, suspicion (mixed)
stir up	controversy, anger, opposition (negative)
generate	excitement, interest, enthusiasm (positive)
provoke	outrage, criticism, debate (negative)

Complete the sentences with the correct collocation from the table above.

1. The unusual new logo _____ a lot of criticism online within hours of its release.

2. A well-designed workspace can _____ real creativity in a team.

3. The bright colours of the packaging _____ curiosity even in people who weren't looking to buy anything.

4. Nostalgic design choices often _____ strong childhood memories in older customers.

UNDERSTANDING KEY VOCABULARY

Article 2

2 The sentences below are about rebranding. Choose the correct meaning (a, b or c) for the word in bold.

1. The new packaging design faced strong **opposition to** its bright colour scheme from long-time customers.

a support for

b disagreement with

c confusion about

2. Fans immediately noticed that the redesigned logo **resembles** the company's very first version from decades ago.

a looks like

b is completely different from

c is an improvement on

3. Choosing a new logo colour is a **strategic** decision that can take marketing teams months to finalise.

a unplanned and rushed

b related only to cost

c carefully planned to achieve a goal

4. She is considered the **foremost** expert on colour psychology in advertising today.

a most experienced and well-known

b most controversial

c least experienced

5. After customer feedback, the designers **refined** the icon, making small improvements rather than starting over.

a completely replaced

b improved with small changes

c made more complicated

6. Many shoppers **associate** the colour green with eco-friendly products, even before reading the label.

a confuse

b mentally connect

c avoid

7. A **distinctive** logo helps a brand stand out immediately, even in a crowded market.

a easily forgettable

b easy to recognise and different from others

c expensive to produce

WHY DO BRANDS REBRAND?

1. Every few years, a familiar logo quietly disappears and a new one takes its place — sometimes to almost no reaction, and sometimes to a wave of public **opposition to** the change so loud it makes international news. Rebranding, changing a company's visual identity and sometimes its whole message, is rarely a casual decision; it's usually the result of a strategic process that can take marketing teams months, or even years, to complete.

2. Companies rebrand for different reasons. Some have simply grown up: a business that started decades ago with a busy, detailed logo often finds that a **refined**, simplified version fits a modern, mobile-first world far better than the original ever could. Others rebrand because their reputation, fairly or not, has become tangled up with something they'd rather leave behind — a fast-food chain distancing itself from concerns about its food, for instance, may quietly remove language that customers **associate** with those old worries.

3. Timing matters enormously. Some companies wait until a logo starts to look dated, no longer feeling current to a younger audience raised on newer visual trends. Others act because of a shift in what they actually do: a photocopier company that now sells a much wider range of office technology may rebrand specifically to stop customers assuming it still only makes one product.

4. New platforms create pressure too. As more of daily life moves onto small screens, logos that once worked beautifully printed large on a building or a truck can struggle to survive shrunk down to a tiny, blurry app icon. Several major tech companies have simplified their logos for exactly this reason, dropping fine detail that simply disappears at a small size.

5. Rebranding is not without real risk, however. When one soft-drink company briefly replaced its familiar packaging with a plainer, more generic design, sales dropped noticeably within weeks — shoppers, it turned out, were specifically looking for a design that **resembles** what they already knew, and the company quietly brought the original back. Elsewhere, a **foremost** example of a successful large-scale redesign is a search engine's colourful logo, which now subtly transforms itself for different products while keeping the same core shapes and colours recognisable throughout.

6. What almost every successful rebrand shares, though, is restraint: keeping just enough of the original that loyal customers still associate the new version with the brand they already trust, while making it feel fresh enough for a new generation. A logo that changes too much, too fast, risks losing the very **distinctive** identity that made it valuable in the first place — proof that in design, as in most things, sometimes less really is more.

DISCUSSION

Work with a partner. Discuss the questions.

1 Think of a logo you dislike. What would you change about it, and why?

2 Do you think companies rebrand too often, or not often enough? Why?

GRAMMAR FOR WRITING

GRAMMAR

Defining relative clauses, omission & reduced clauses

Defining relative clauses add essential information that identifies exactly which person, thing, or place we mean — without them, the sentence would be unclear or incomplete. Unlike non-defining clauses, they use no commas, and the relative pronoun can sometimes be left out or reduced to a participle.

The rules below explain when a relative pronoun (who / which / that / where) is needed, when it can be dropped, and when the whole clause can be reduced to a participle phrase.

1. Use **who/that for people, and which/that for things,** to identify exactly which one you mean — no commas.

The designer who created the logo later became famous for minimalist branding

2. Use **whose** to show possession inside a defining clause.

A company whose logo changes too often can confuse loyal customers.

3. Use **where** for a place, in the sense of '**in/at which**' — it cannot be omitted.

This is the workshop where our designers create new prototypes.

4. The relative pronoun CAN be omitted when it is the OBJECT of the clause (not the subject).

The logo (that) the team designed last year is still in use today.

5. *The relative pronoun* ***CANNOT be omitted*** *when it is the SUBJECT of the clause.*

The designer who redesigned the logo now works for a different company.

6. *A clause with* ***which/that + verb*** *can often be reduced to a participle phrase: drop the pronoun and change the verb to* ***-ing.***

There are delays for people who travel to work on Southern Region trains. → There are delays for people travelling to work on Southern Region trains.

Exercise A — Complete the paragraph with a relative pronoun where it is needed. Leave the space blank if the pronoun can be omitted.

The designer (1) _____ created our new logo studied graphic design in Milan. She used a colour palette (2) _____ she chose after months of research. The client (3) _____ she worked with wanted something modern but timeless. The first sketch (4) _____ she showed us in April was completely different from the final version. A logo (5) _____ works well in black and white usually works everywhere. The agency (6) _____ we hired last year has redesigned dozens of well-known brands. The feedback (7) _____ the team received from focus groups shaped almost every decision. The version (8) _____ finally launched in June kept the original colours but simplified the shape.

Exercise D — Combine each pair of sentences into one, using where or a reduced participle clause as shown in the rules above.

1. The design studio is in the old power station. Our designers create new prototypes there. (where)

2. The rebrand leads to instant recognition. It cost the company millions. (participle)

3. This is the exhibition hall. Visitors can see the winning designs there. (where)

4. The new logo appeals to a younger audience. It has boosted sales significantly. (participle)

ACADEMIC WRITING

Paraphrasing — expressing other people's ideas in your own words

ACADEMIC WRITING SKILL

Paraphrasing

Paraphrasing means expressing someone else's idea in your own words, using different vocabulary and sentence structures, without changing the original meaning. It's essential when summarising a source, and if you keep any of the original wording, it must go in quotation marks.

ORIGINAL: *A good logo must also be unique so it will not be confused with the logo from another organisation.*

PARAPHRASE: *For a logo to work well, it needs a distinctive design so people don't mix it up with a rival's.*

Paraphrase the sentences below in your own words, without copying the original phrasing.

1 Logos should be flexible enough to adapt across time and placement.

_____

2 The public generally resists changes to familiar logos at first.

_____

3 More than anything else, a logo needs to tell a story.

_____

4 Some companies simply need a new logo to show that they have matured as a business.

_____

5 A distinctive logo helps a brand stand out immediately, even in a crowded market.

_____

WRITING TASK

Write a short paragraph (80–100 words) paraphrasing an opinion you've read or heard about branding or design — from an article, a friend, or this unit — without copying the original wording directly.

READING PRACTICE

PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of Headings:

A) Legacy of Sassanids.

B) Once nomadic, then an empire.

C) The fall of the Empire.

D) Commercial influence.

E) Melting pot of nations.

F) Four major beliefs.

G) The distributor of faith.

H) In the middle of great civilizations.

15. Paragraph I

16. Paragraph II

17. Paragraph III

18. Paragraph IV

19. Paragraph V

20. Paragraph VI

KUSHAN EMPIRE

I. The Kushan Empire was a significant cultural and political entity that flourished in Central Asia and Northern India between the 1st and 3rd centuries CE. Its origins trace back to the Yuezhi, a nomadic group from the steppes of Central Asia. They established control over Bactria, a Hellenistic region, blending Greek, Persian, and Indian influences. The Kushans were instrumental in fostering trade along the Silk Road, connecting the East and West. Under their rule, arts, religion, and commerce flourished, making them a vital link in the ancient world's cultural and economic exchanges.

II. The Kushan Empire spanned a vast territory, including present-day Afghanistan, Pakistan, Northern India, and parts of Central Asia. It was strategically located along major trade routes, particularly the Silk Road. The empire's geographic position allowed it to act as a bridge between the Mediterranean, China, and Indian spheres of influences. This connectivity facilitated not only trade but also the exchange of ideas, technologies, and cultural practices. The Kushans expanded their influence through military conquests and diplomacy, securing their position as a dominant power in the region for over two centuries.

III. The Kushan Empire was pivotal in the flourishing of the Silk Road, a network of trade routes connecting Asia to Europe. The empire served as a hub for the exchange of goods such as silk, spices, gemstones, and textiles. Kushan coins, widely circulated, reflect their role in trade and economic integration. The Kushans also promoted caravanserais and security along trade routes, ensuring safe passage for merchants. This vibrant trade network enriched the empire economically and culturally, fostering interactions between diverse civilizations.

IV. Kushan art is a testament to the empire's diverse cultural influences, blending Greek, Indian, Persian, and Central Asian styles. The Gandhara School of Art, which thrived during their reign, is renowned for its Greco-Buddhist sculptures, particularly depictions of the Buddha. The Kushans were patrons of various art forms, including architecture, sculpture, and coinage. These artistic expressions not only reflected their cosmopolitan society but also played a significant role in spreading Buddhist iconography and religious ideas across Asia.

V. The Kushan Empire was a melting pot of religions, including Buddhism, Hinduism, Zoroastrianism, and Greek polytheism. They were instrumental in the spread of Buddhism to Central Asia and China. Emperor Kanishka, a notable Kushan ruler, convened the Fourth Buddhist Council, which contributed to the development of Mahayana Buddhism. The empire's tolerance and support for multiple faiths fostered a rich spiritual environment, influencing religious practices far beyond its borders.

VI. The decline of the Kushan Empire began in the 3rd century CE due to internal conflicts and external invasions, particularly by the Sassanid Empire and the Gupta Empire. Despite its fall, the Kushan Empire left a lasting legacy. It played a critical role in the cultural and economic integration of the ancient world. The empire's contributions to art, religion, and trade continue to be studied and celebrated, highlighting its importance in the history of Central and South Asia.

📌 Wordlist

1. entity ▢
2. flourish ▢
3. trace back to ▢
4. steppe ▢
5. nomadic ▢
6. blend ▢
7. establish control ▢
8. foster trade ▢
9. commerce ▢
10. vital link ▢
11. span ▢
12. trade route ▢
13. act a bridge ▢
14. spheres of influence ▢
15. facilitate ▢
16. military conquest ▢
17. dominant power ▢
18. pivotal ▢
19. serve as a hub ▢
20. reflect ▢
21. diverse ▢
22. patron ▢
23. spread ▢
24. be renowned for ▢
25. faith ▢
26. far beyond ▢
27. spiritual ▢
28. religious practice ▢
29. internal conflict ▢
30. legacy ▢

LISTENING PODCAST

TASK 1

📺 **Listen to the podcast and answer the questions.**

1. Liam says that Parkour is …

a. a type of military training.

b. a means of jumping off high buildings.

c. a way of overcoming obstacles.

d. a kind of video.

2. Liam's main job is …

a. to check the bikes are safe.

b. to clean the ramps.

c. to do demonstrations.

d. to teach young people about BMX.

3. Which area did Liam not have training in?

a. giving medical attention.

b. cooking hamburgers.

c. food hygiene.

d. basic accounting.

4.Why did Debbie volunteer the second time?

a. to be more competitive in the job market.

b. to help other people.

c. to complete her degree course.

d. to learn how to train volunteers.

5. Which sport did Debbie not volunteer to help with?

a. cricket

b. swimming

c. table tennis

d. football

6. Debbie and Liam both say that …

a. it's important to pay people to work in sport.

b. volunteers are often exploited.

c. they love volunteering.

d. volunteers are essential for sport.

TASK 2

Match the two parts of the phrase and write a–h next to the numbers 1–8.

1…….. to do	a. an experience
2…….. to overcome	b. a job
3…….. to volunteer	c. safety standards
4…….. to meet	d. to help
5…….. to organise	e. experience
6…….. to gain	f. an event
7…….. to deal with	g. the public
8…….. to share	h. an obstacle

TASK 3

Scan to watch video

📝 **Watch the video and write a summary.**

- the main topic

- the key points

- important examples or facts

Write a 100–150 word summary in your own words.

LISTENING PRACTICE

PART 3

You will hear people speaking in different situations. Match each speaker (15-18) to the description they give about another person(A-F). There are TWO EXTRA options

Speaker 1 ...

Speaker 2 ...

Speaker 3 ...

Speaker 4 ...

A) to strengthen a relationship
B) to get some personal space
C) to help deal with extensive responsibilities
D) to meet the demands of colleagues
E) to cope with unpredictability
F) to avoid unfair criticism

Phrases & Idioms Wordlist

Stretched to the limit: Pushed as far as possible; almost exhausted (regarding patience or resources).

Squirrel (oneself) away: To hide or isolate oneself in a quiet, secluded place.

Fresh-faced: Looking healthy, youthful, and full of energy.

Stunned silence: Complete quiet caused by surprise or shock.

Make a drastic decision: To make a severe, extreme, or radical choice.

Can't get enough of (something): To enjoy something so much that you want more and more of it.

Let's face it: Let us be realistic and accept the truth of a situation.

Get on someone's nerves: To annoy or irritate someone a lot.

Make one's blood boil: To cause someone to become very angry.

Self-imposed: A rule, task, or restriction that you decide to put on yourself, rather than having someone else force it on you.

Not have a clue: To be completely ignorant or unaware of something.

Live on air: Broadcasting in real-time without pre-recording.

Tear one's hair out: To show extreme frustration, stress, or anxiety.

Throw (something) into complete disarray: To cause total confusion, disorder, or chaos.

Bear in mind: To remember or consider a specific piece of information.

Get worked up: To become upset, stressed, or overly emotional about something.

WRITING PART 1.2

USEFUL LANGUAGE — Formal letter

Function	Useful phrases
Opening	*Dear Sir/Madam, / Dear [Title], / I am writing in response to your recent email regarding...*
Reacting / feelings	*I was pleased/disappointed to learn that... / I must admit I have some concerns about...*
Giving a suggestion	*I believe it would be beneficial to... / I would suggest that... / It might be worth considering...*
Requesting a reply	*I would be grateful if you could... / I look forward to hearing your thoughts on this.*
Closing	*Thank you for taking the time to consider this. / Yours faithfully, / Yours sincerely,*

PART 1.1 PRACTICE

You are a member of a local Design Society. You received this email from the society's director.

Dear Member,
I'm writing to let you know that our Design Society building will be closed for six weeks starting next month for a major renovation, including a full redesign of our exhibition space and workshop rooms. We want to create a more modern, inspiring environment for our members. During this time, we'd love to hear your ideas for how the new space could be designed, or what facilities you'd like to see included. Your feedback means a great deal to us.
Best wishes,
The Director

Task 1.1 —Write a letter to your friend, who is also a member of the Design Society. Write about your feelings and what you think the new space should include. Write about 50 words..

RULES for Task 1.2 (formal letter)

☐ Respond to the SAME message as Task 1.1 — cover the same two things (feelings + opinion/ suggestion), but in more depth.

☐ Aim for 120–150 words — several short paragraphs, not one block of text.

☐ Use a formal register throughout: no contractions, polite and impersonal phrasing.

☐ Structure it clearly: an opening line, your reaction, your suggestion(s) in detail, and a polite closing.

☐ Open with Dear Sir/Madam or Dear [Title], and close with Yours faithfully/sincerely.

☐ Use a wider range of grammar than Task 1.1 — relative clauses, passive forms, and formal linking words (furthermore, given that, in addition).

SAMPLE ANSWER

Dear Director,
Thank you for informing members about the upcoming renovation of the Design Society building. While I understand the necessity of these upgrades, I must admit I am a little disappointed that the space will be unavailable for six weeks, as I regularly attend the workshop sessions there.
That said, I very much welcome the opportunity to contribute ideas for the redesign. I would suggest including a dedicated area for digital design work, with computers and software for members interested in graphic design, alongside the traditional workshop spaces.
It would also be beneficial to install better natural lighting in the exhibition space, as this would make displayed work look far more professional. Additionally, I believe a small café area could encourage members to stay longer and socialise after sessions, which might help build a stronger sense of community.
Thank you again for considering members' feedback. I look forward to seeing the new space when it reopens.
Yours faithfully, N. Yusupova

TASK 1.2 PRACTICE — now you try, with a new message

You are a member of a local Photography & Design Club. You received this email from the club's chairperson.

Dear Member,

I'm delighted to announce that our club has been offered a new, larger space in the city's Arts Quarter, and we're planning to move next month. Before we finalise the layout, we would like to hear your suggestions for how the new space should be organised — for example, areas for printing, exhibitions, or workshops. Please let us know your thoughts.

Kind regards,
The Chairperson

Task 1.2 —Write a letter to the Chairperson. Write about your feelings about the move and what you think the new space should include. Write about 120–150 words.

SPEAKING PART 2

QUESTIONS

Describe a product or brand whose design you really admire.

You should say:

- ☐ what the product or brand is
- ☐ what you like about its design
- ☐ how the design makes you feel or behave

…and say whether you think design generally influences your own buying decisions.

SAMPLE ANSWER

*I'd like to talk about my phone, which I think has a **genuinely distinctive design**. What immediately **stands out** is how minimalist it looks — there's barely a single unnecessary line or button, and the whole thing feels incredibly smooth in your hand. What I really love about it is the way the colour and shape seem to **convey a sense of quality** without the brand needing to say a word about it.*

Using it every day actually makes me feel a bit more organised, if that doesn't sound strange — because everything about the design is so clean, I find myself wanting to keep my apps and files just as tidy. It's a small thing, but it does shape how I behave with it.

As for** whether design influences my buying decisions in general, I'd say it absolutely does, maybe more than I'd like to admit. I've definitely paid more for a product purely because it looked better, even when a cheaper option would have worked just as well. Overall, I think good design isn't just decoration — it genuinely changes how a product feels to use, and that's often **worth paying for.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Introducing the topic:	*I'd like to talk about... / One product whose design I really admire is...*
Describing appearance:	*It's got a really sleek/minimalist/bold design... / What stands out is...*
Explaining why you like it:	*What I love about it is... / It really appeals to me because...*
Describing the effect on you:	*It makes me feel... / Every time I use/see it, I...*
Giving a wider opinion:	*In general, I think design plays a huge role in... / Personally, I tend to...*
Concluding:	*Overall, ... / To sum up, ...*